

CRISP-E Prompting Formula

A practical prompting framework designed for real business owners — not tech enthusiasts. Use this structure to brief AI properly, reduce revisions, and get higher-quality outputs first time.

C — CONTEXT

- Explain the situation, business type, audience and constraints.
- State the real problem clearly.
- Include what is currently happening and why it matters.

R — ROLE

- Tell the AI who to act as (operations manager, strategist, consultant).
- Choose a perspective that matches the task.

I — INSTRUCTION

- Use one clear action verb: Create, Analyse, Build, Rewrite.
- Avoid stacking multiple conflicting tasks.

S — SPECIFICATION

- Define format (SOP, bullets, table, headings).
- Specify tone (plain English, professional, direct).
- Set structural rules or limits if needed.

P — PERFORMANCE

- Define what success looks like (save time, reduce errors, increase sales).
- State practical or measurable outcomes.

E — EXAMPLE / TONE

- Provide sample wording if possible.
- Clarify style and what it should not sound like.

CRISP-E Copy-and-Use Prompt Template

CONTEXT: Explain background, situation and constraints.

ROLE: Act as a [specific professional role].

INSTRUCTION: Create / Analyse / Build / Rewrite...

SPECIFICATION: Define format, tone, structure and length.

PERFORMANCE: The result must achieve...

EXAMPLE / TONE: Use wording similar to... Avoid sounding like...

Quick Prompt Audit Checklist

- Have I explained the situation clearly?
- Have I defined the AI's role?
- Have I given one clear instruction?
- Have I specified format and tone?
- Have I defined what success looks like?
- Have I guided the style?

Most people treat AI like Google. Serious business owners brief it like a capable employee. CRISP-E is the difference between average output and operational leverage.